What Our Agents Told Us: Field Research, Explained Simply

Oct 25, 2026 · @Designer Nesil Noble

In 28 sessions across 10 markets, agencies said the same thing: they lose time on unclear documents, stale course data and not knowing what is happening with an application. This doc retells the GSP field report (23 Sep to 14 Oct 2026) in plain words, alongside what four competitor portals already do.

1. Who we heard from

We spoke to agencies in 10 markets, including our most loyal and our happiest partners, and both groups raised the same product gaps. Round one had 15 sessions; round two added 13 more, covering six new markets and four more agencies in Bangladesh. Agencies are named RP1 to RP28.

Market	Agencies	Who they are
India (Haryana and Hyderabad)	RP1 to RP10	Haryana includes a regional director who sends 90% of his applications through GSP. Hyderabad teams have used the portal for two years or more
Nepal	RP11 to RP12	A former GSP BDM now running her own agency, and a multi-country group that rates GSP highly
Sri Lanka	RP13	One group session with 4 agencies
Bangladesh	RP14 to RP15	Eduwire and Unilink; both prefer GSP to Adventus and ApplyBoard
Pakistan	RP16	A large agency that rates GSP's responsiveness best of the platforms it uses
Philippines	RP17	A visa consultancy that sends Australia to GSP and Canada to ApplyBoard
Myanmar	RP18	Session held, but no notes were taken, so it isn't counted

Market	Agencies	Who they are
Bangladesh, round two	RP19 to RP22	One with "no missing features", one asking for a training hub, two struggling with status and notifications
Australia	RP23 to RP24	One compares us with Crizac on offer speed; the other raised filters, passport scanning and duplicate-student blocks
Indonesia	RP25 to RP26	One calls GSP its top master agent; the other was promised a shared-documents fix
Vietnam	RP27 to RP28	A partner since 2017 that calls GSP its best master agent there, and an agency that praises the local team

Even our happiest agencies asked for: fresher course data (they check fees and entry marks on ChatGPT when the portal disagrees with the university), scholarship information, a notes channel that gets answered, and training for new staff.

Our own operations data agrees:

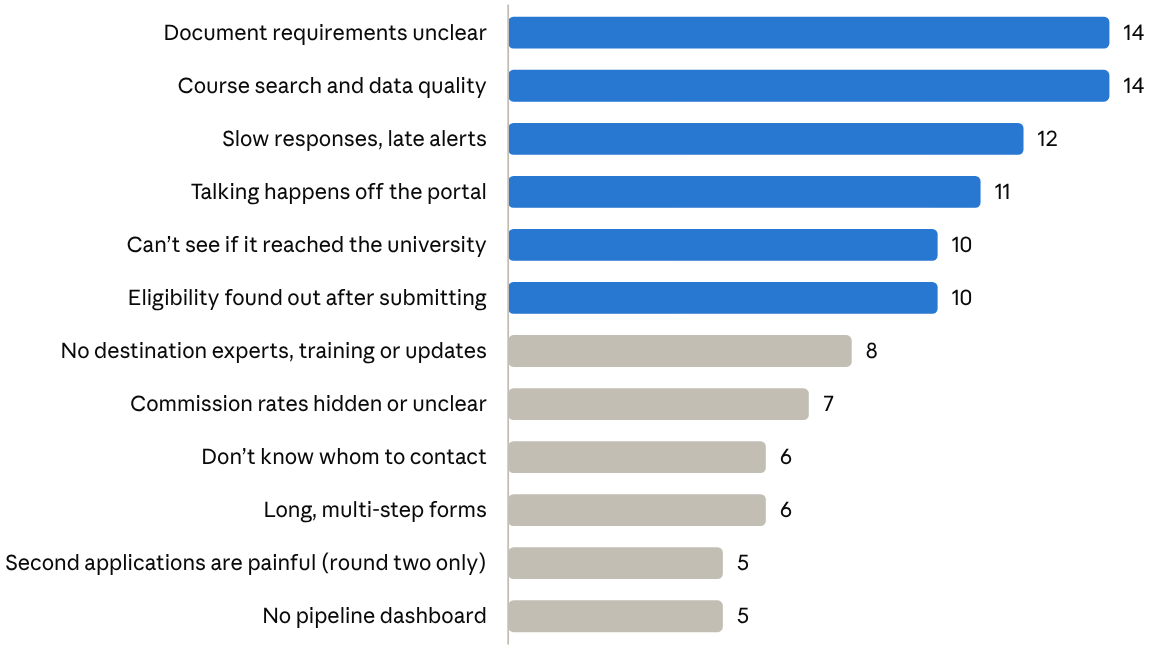
- Hiding commission rates from agency admins causes 3 to 4 trust queries a week (Nepal, Bangladesh, Philippines, India).
- The central triage step adds a full day before an India application is picked up, and the India admissions team couldn't say what it adds.
- Nobody in the business could explain why the enrolment step exists separately from the application.

2. The twelve problems agents raised

The top six problems are all about documents, data and not knowing what is happening. Counts are out of 27 sessions with notes (15 in round one, 12 in round two).

Documents and course data top the list, each raised in 14 of 27 sessions

Sessions that raised each problem, out of 27. The top six are highlighted.



GSP field report, sessions with notes · 23 Sep to 14 Oct 2026

What each problem means, in the agencies' terms:

1. **Document requirements unclear:** no mandatory list, no templates, no validity dates, and checklists that aren't country-specific.
2. **Course search and data quality:** missing courses, stale fees and intakes, about 20 fields to fill, exact-match search only.
3. **Slow responses, late alerts:** pending-item alerts arrive up to 2 days late; 3 to 4 day waits; 2 to 3 hand-offs per question.
4. **Talking happens off the portal:** notes go unanswered, so WhatsApp and email win.
5. **Can't see if it reached the university:** a generic "In Process" status and no submission confirmation.
6. **Eligibility found out after submitting:** territory, school board and score rejections arrive days later.
7. **No destination experts, training or updates:** no training hub, news feed or direct country contact.
8. **Commission rates hidden or unclear:** rates were removed; GSP's share vs the agency's share is unclear; invoicing happens off the platform.

9. **Don't know whom to contact:** several contacts per application, BDM details buried, or the handler has left.
10. **Long, multi-step forms:** too many compulsory fields and steps to start an application.
11. **Second applications are painful:** documents re-uploaded, a cap on applications, and a duplicate-student block (round two only).
12. **No pipeline dashboard:** no offer-stage filter, export, task view or view per counsellor.

3. In their words

Agencies are already comparing us with competitors by name. These are close paraphrases from session notes.

Round one

- "Counsellors still lack clarity on the portal after using it for two years." RP7, Hyderabad
- "Pending-item notifications reach us up to two days late, which delays documents, lodgement and the offer." RP1, Haryana (90% of volume via GSP)
- "Response time is the top factor in choosing a platform partner." RP8, Hyderabad
- "Crizac launches an application with only six questions." RP13, Sri Lanka group
- "We applied to Torrens through GSP and were rejected two days later because Nepal wasn't in scope. KC flags that before you apply." RP11, Nepal
- "When the portal's tuition fee or entry marks don't match the university, we check on ChatGPT." RP14, Bangladesh
- "Head office decides which portal to use based on university commission rates, not usability." RP7, Hyderabad
- "I won't use GSP for Germany or New Zealand yet. KC Overseas has a five-person NZ team that knows Nepal documents." RP11, Nepal
- "When commissions are equal, we choose on how counsellor-friendly the application is and how transparent the turnaround time is." RP13, Sri Lanka group

Round two

- "We submit without knowing whether the institute accepts our territory, then hear one or two days later that it doesn't. By then another agent may have the student." RP16, Pakistan
- "We'd like training videos and university updates inside the portal, the way ApplyBoard has a Training Hub." RP19, Bangladesh

- "We upload the same documents three times for three applications." RP21, Bangladesh
- "Crizac gives an offer within 24 hours of the mandatory documents. With GSP and KC it takes two to three days." RP23, Australia
- "Merged academic documents aren't checked, and the same document is asked for again on every application thread." RP24, Australia
- "Searching 'University of Adelaide' finds nothing now that it's called 'Adelaide University'." RP25, Indonesia
- "Of 26 Japanese universities, only one is visible to us for Indonesia." RP26, Indonesia
- "Make the application staged: personal details first, then academics, with financial details optional." RP28, Vietnam

Six things round two found that round one didn't

1. **Territory and contract status are invisible.** Pakistan submits blind and hears of a rejection 1 to 2 days later. Institutes with ended contracts still appear in search, and the territory pop-up fires even on institutes that accept the territory, so agents ignore it. In Indonesia, 25 of 26 Japanese universities have no Indonesia recruiting rights yet.
2. **Documents are re-uploaded for every application.** The same visa copy, CoE and academics are asked for again on each thread. Indonesia was told a shared document section is 1 to 2 months away.
3. **Notifications miss the right person.** A second application added days later went unnoticed. Emails still go to the previous handler. When an application is declined after enrolment, nobody is told, and the agent finds out 3 to 4 days later.
4. **Agents don't know what the portal can do.** Our partner since 2017 submits by email because it assumes the portal needs heavy uploads; it doesn't. It also didn't know counsellors can be added. Some gaps are awareness, not features.
5. **The data gaps are specific.** Canada PGWP eligibility isn't shown per programme. Scholarships are missing at programme level (being added). Intakes and deadlines are unreliable; tuition is about 90% accurate. Search fails on renamed universities.
6. **Agents bring benchmarks from other platforms:** ApplyBoard's training hub, wallet and task view; DreamApply's staged application; Crizac's 24-hour offers.

4. Problems by market

Product gaps show up in every market; service gaps (slow replies, not knowing whom to call) cluster in India and Australia. **Strong** means most agencies there raised it; **Raised** means at least one did; **Praised** means agencies called it out as good. Myanmar isn't included.

Problem	Strong in	Raised in	Praised in
Course search and data freshness	India, Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, Philippines, Indonesia	Nepal, Pakistan, Australia, Vietnam	
Talking happens off the portal	India, Bangladesh, Philippines	Nepal, Pakistan, Australia, Indonesia, Vietnam	
Eligibility found out after submitting	India, Nepal, Pakistan	Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, Philippines, Indonesia	
Commission rates hidden or unclear	Nepal, Sri Lanka	India, Bangladesh, Australia, Indonesia	Pakistan, Vietnam
Can't see if it reached the university	India, Sri Lanka	Nepal, Bangladesh, Australia	
Forms and UX friction	Sri Lanka, Indonesia, Vietnam	India, Bangladesh, Australia	
Training and destination updates	Vietnam	India, Bangladesh, Australia	
Slow responses, late alerts	India, Australia	Bangladesh, Philippines	Pakistan, Indonesia, Vietnam
Document requirements unclear	India, Pakistan, Indonesia	Bangladesh, Australia, Vietnam	
Don't know whom to contact	India, Nepal	Bangladesh, Australia	
No pipeline dashboard	Sri Lanka, Pakistan	India, Bangladesh	

Problem	Strong in	Raised in	Praised in
Second applications are painful (round two only)	Indonesia	Bangladesh, Australia	

What this means:

- **Product:** course data shows up in all nine markets, talking off the portal in eight, eligibility in seven and documents in six. Process changes alone won't fix these; the portal's data and screens have to change.
- **Service:** slow replies and "whom do I call" pain sit in India, where applications pass through central triage and several hand-offs. Australia is the new pocket, because agents compare us with Crizac's 24-hour offers.
- **Bangladesh:** agencies praise speed and contacts because one local manager answers WhatsApp, but status stays vague and notifications miss people. It depends on one person and none of it is tracked.
- **Vietnam:** mostly awareness. The longest-standing partner submits by email, thinking the portal needs heavy uploads. A short onboarding would fix part of this.

5. How agents choose a platform

Agencies pick a platform by destination first, then by commission, and then by how fast the offer comes and whether they have a named contact.

1. **Destination decides the first cut.** Australia goes to GSP, Canada to ApplyBoard, Europe to KC (RP17, RP19). The choice follows which platform covers the university (RP22). Australia and Canada volumes are down, the US is closed, the UK is competitive and Dubai is emerging (RP23).
2. **Commission comes second, and management often decides.** Routing is set by management on commission and availability (RP26). This works for GSP in Pakistan, Vietnam and one Bangladesh agency, which is paid about a month after the invoice.
3. **Speed and relationship win ties.** Offer-letter speed decides for one Bangladesh agency (RP22). Crizac is preferred for the UK and NZ because of 24-hour offers (RP23). Indonesia's top master agent is GSP because of its named admissions contacts (RP25).

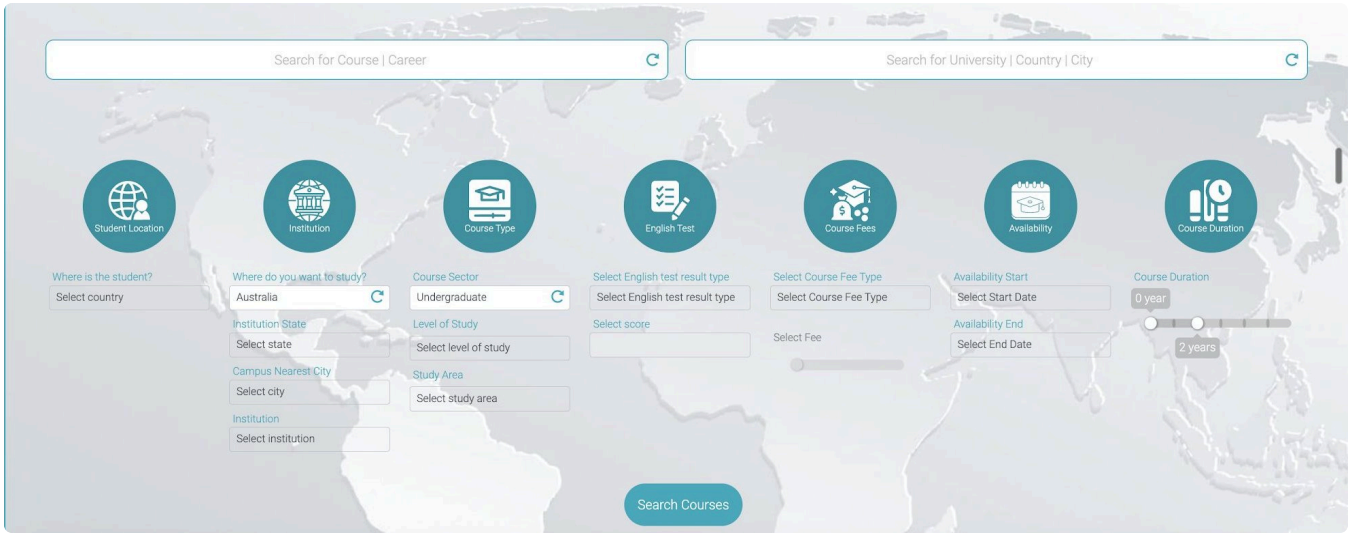
The report's reading: GSP holds Australia by default and loses other destinations on coverage and offer speed. Better screens help agencies who already send us students; wider coverage and faster offers decide who sends us the next one.

6. What today's GSP portal looks like

Today's portal makes agencies fill long forms, read free-text rules and guess what is happening. These are the report's screenshots of the live portal, in the order an agency meets them.

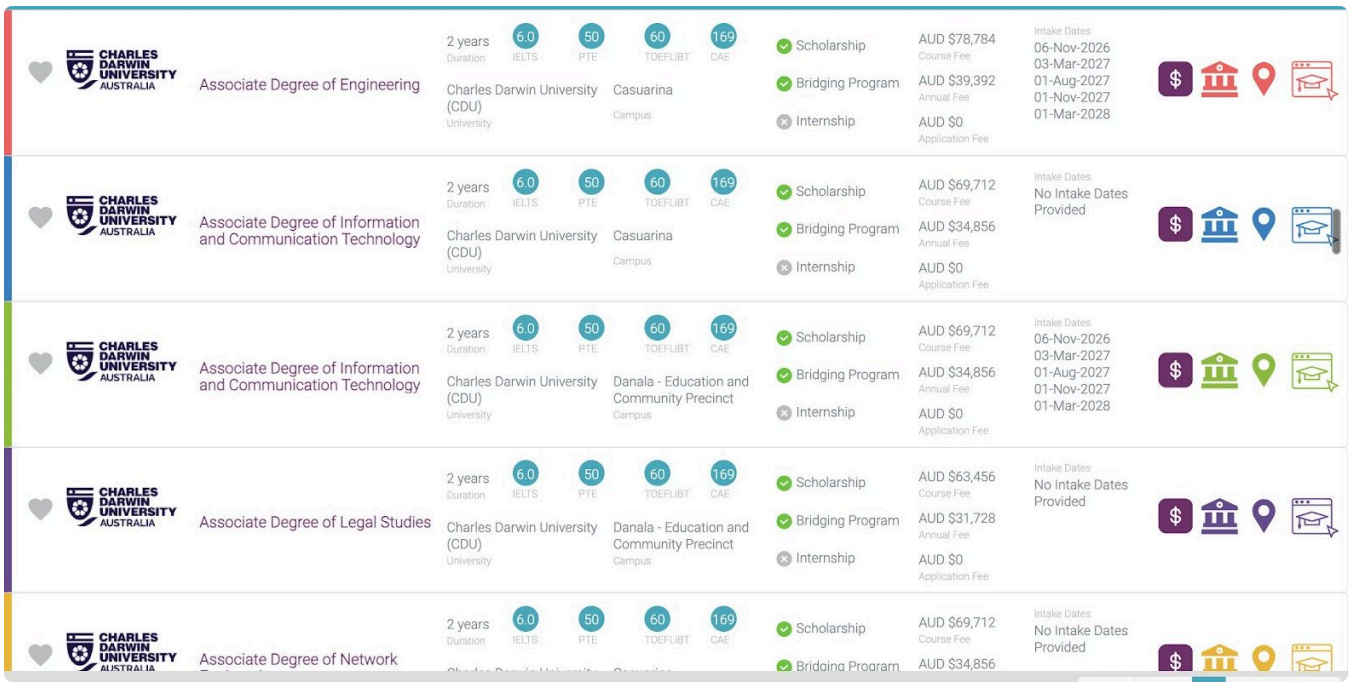
Search: two search boxes and 14 inputs

Search is exact-match only: "Business, Sydney" returns incomplete results (RP11). Agencies count about 20 fields to fill (RP13), 20 filters with duplicate state entries (RP24), and a renamed university can't be found (RP25). There is no "last updated" date on course data.



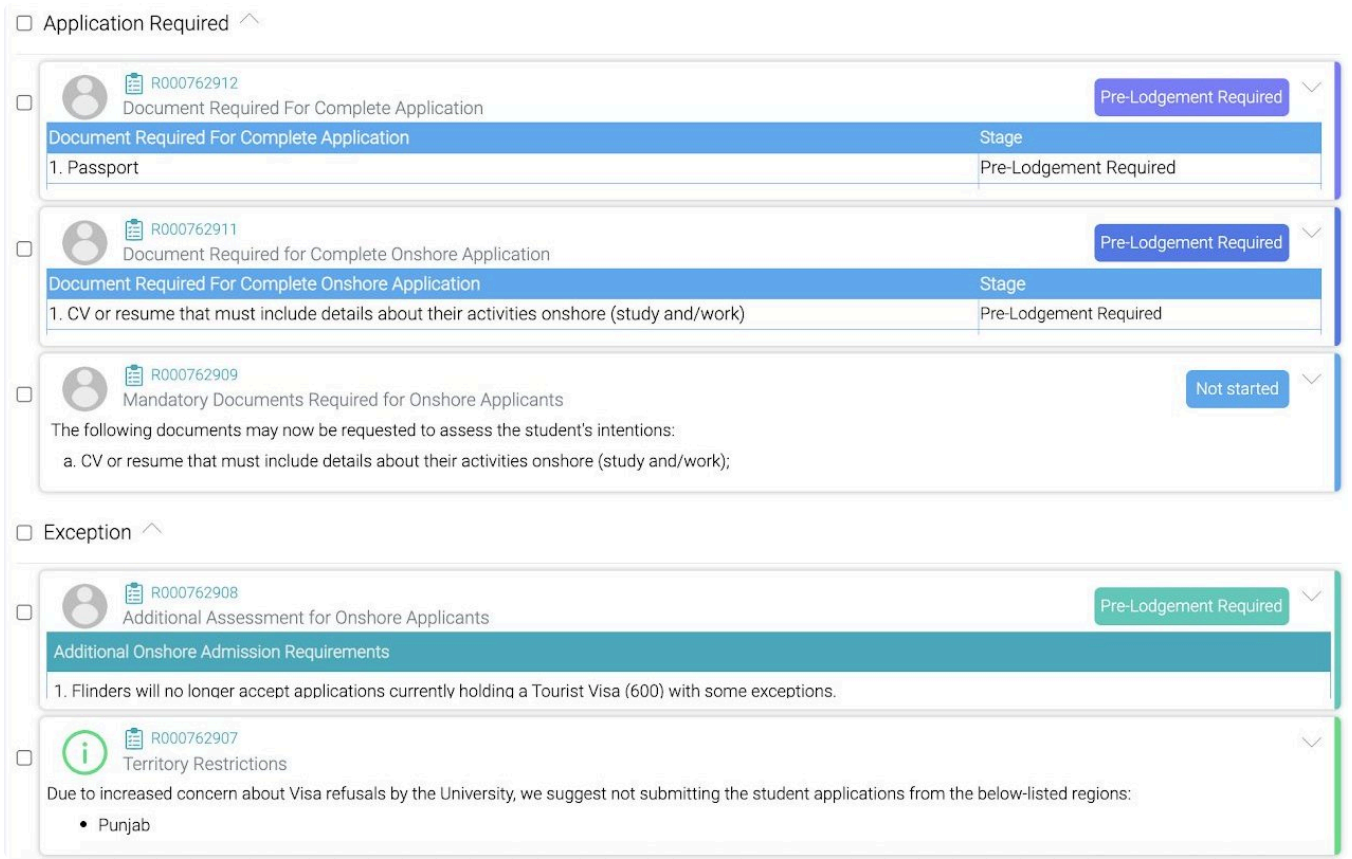
Results: good data, when it is current

Course cards already show IELTS, PTE, TOEFL and CAE scores, scholarship, fees and intakes. This is one thing agencies praise.



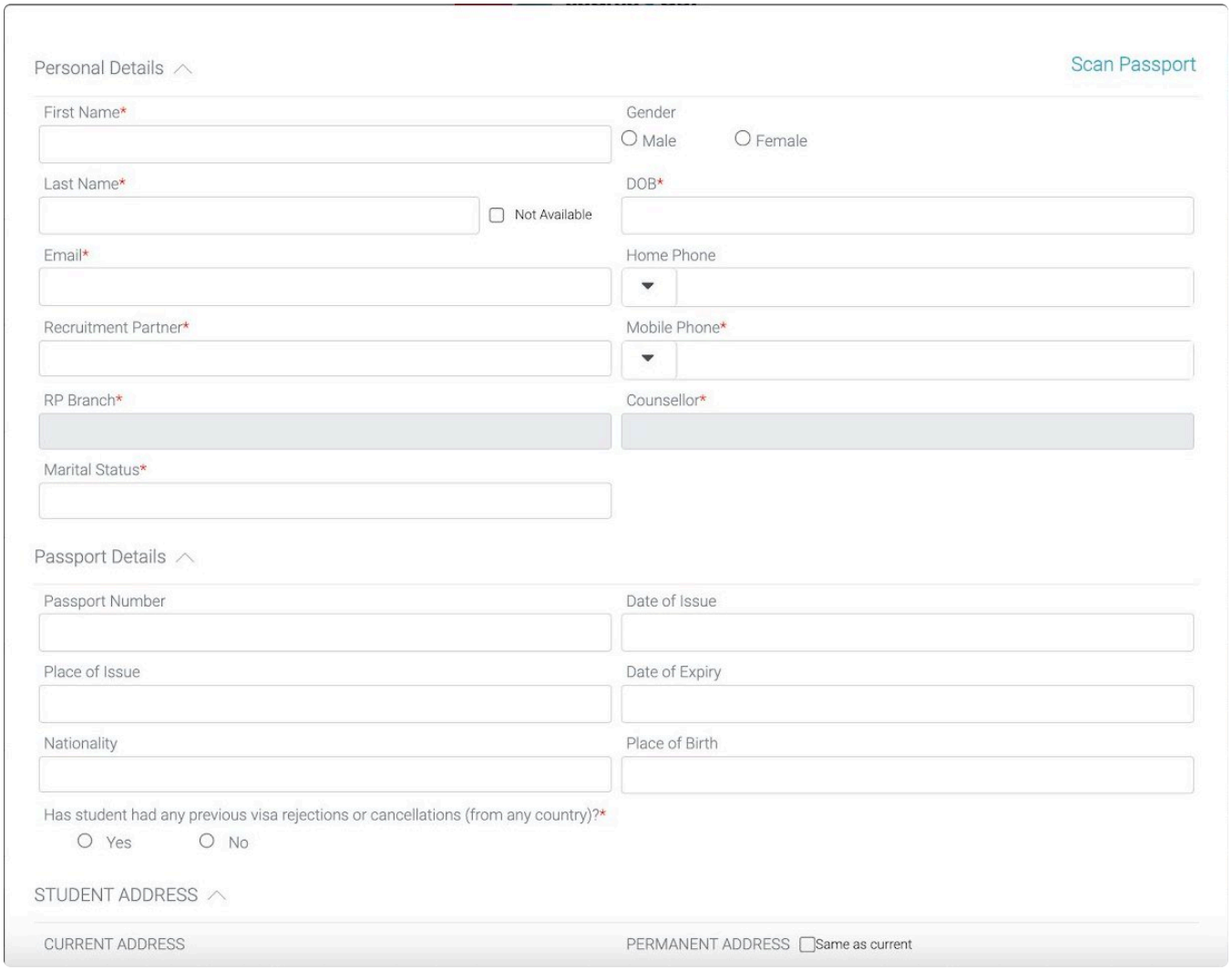
Requirements and eligibility: free-text cards

Rules are written as text cards. The territory rule only "suggests" not submitting from Punjab, so the system can't check, block or remind. Rejections arrive days after submitting.

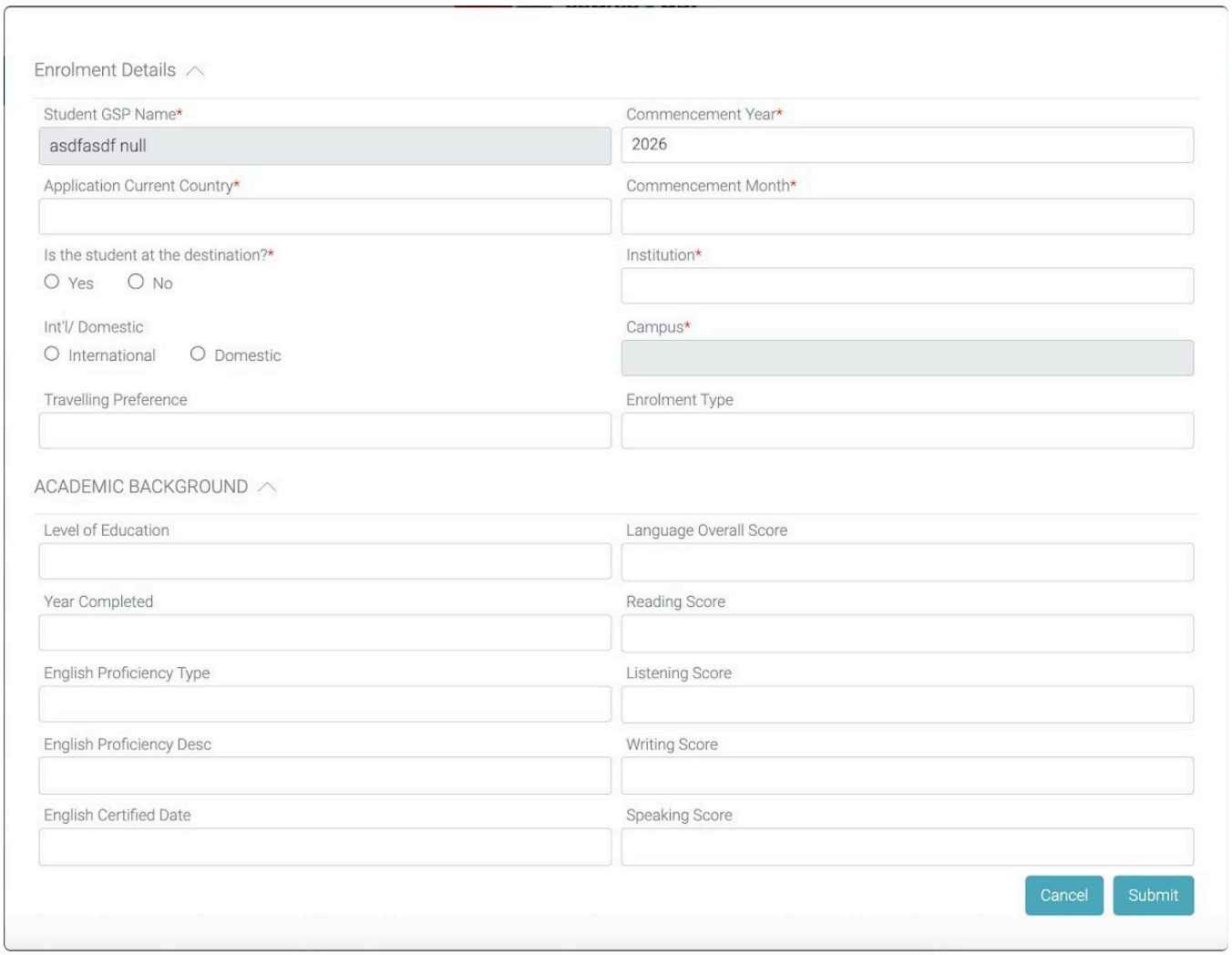


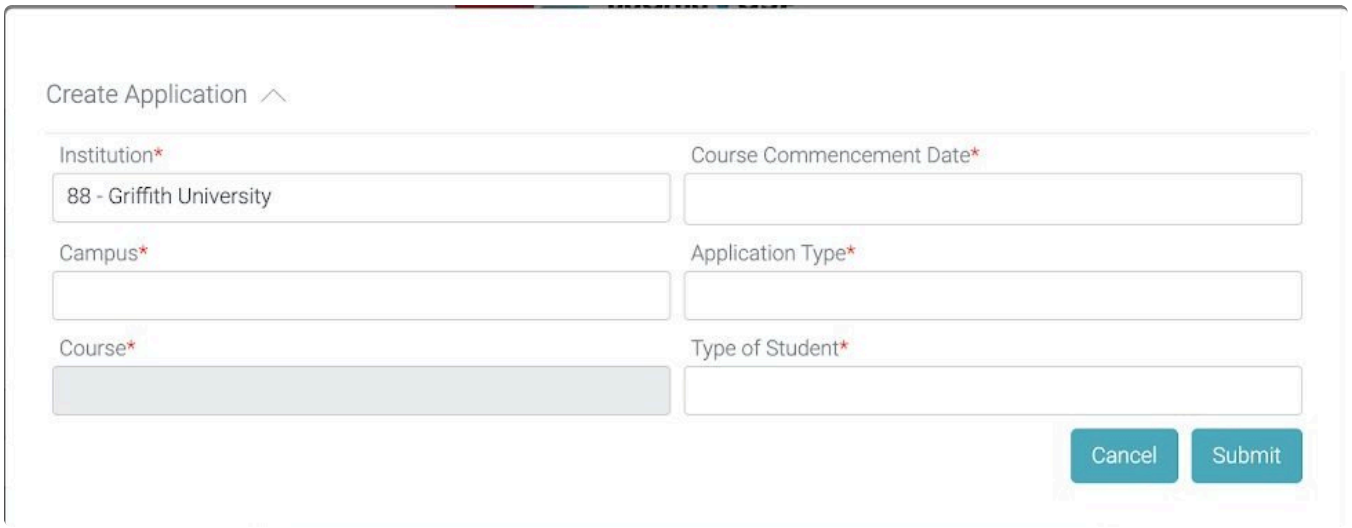
Starting an application: 10 fields, then 20+ more over two forms

Step 1 creates the student: 10 required fields (name, date of birth, email, mobile, agency, branch, counsellor, marital status, visa history) plus passport and address sections.



Step 2 is an enrolment form, then an application form: 26 fields in all, 13 of them mandatory. There is no confirmation after submitting (RP8).





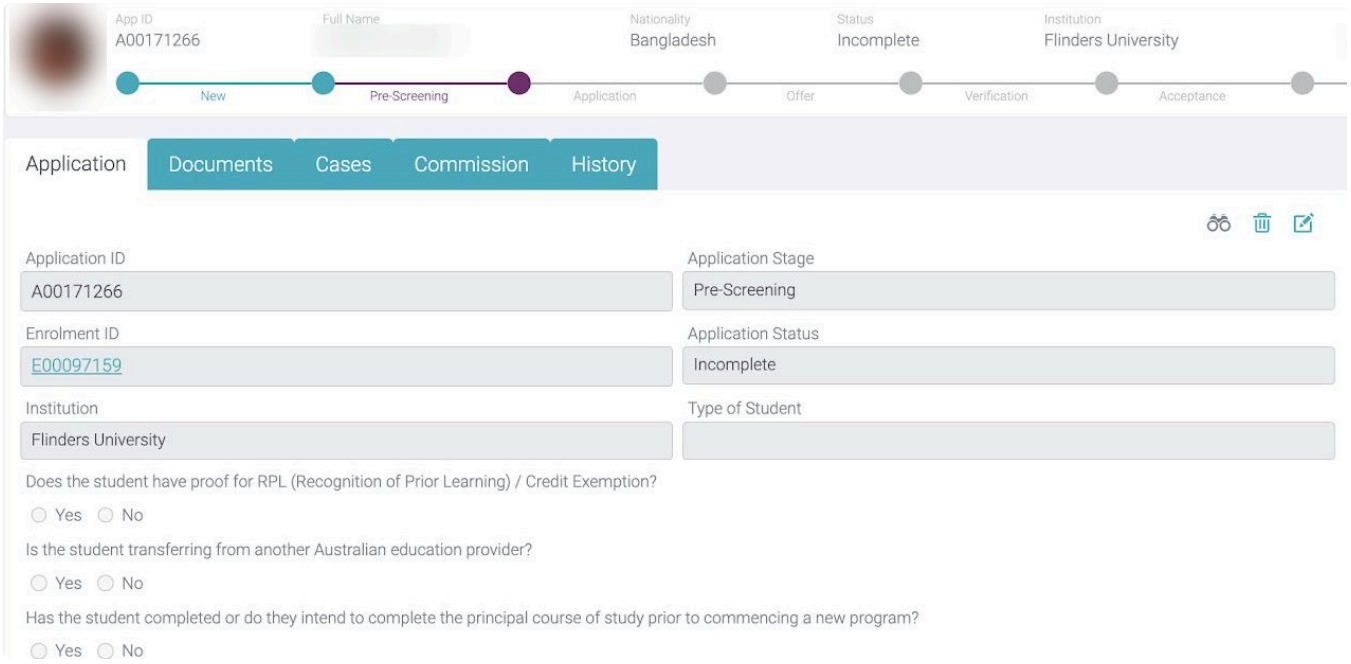
Documents: a flat file list

Agencies bulk-upload 20+ untagged files, and staff re-sort each one by hand. Nothing shows what is mandatory or missing.



After submitting: a stage and a vague status

The agency sees a stage ("Pre-Screening") and a generic status ("Incomplete"). Nothing says who needs to act, or whether the university has it. Notes are invisible after submission, so follow-up moves to email (RP21).

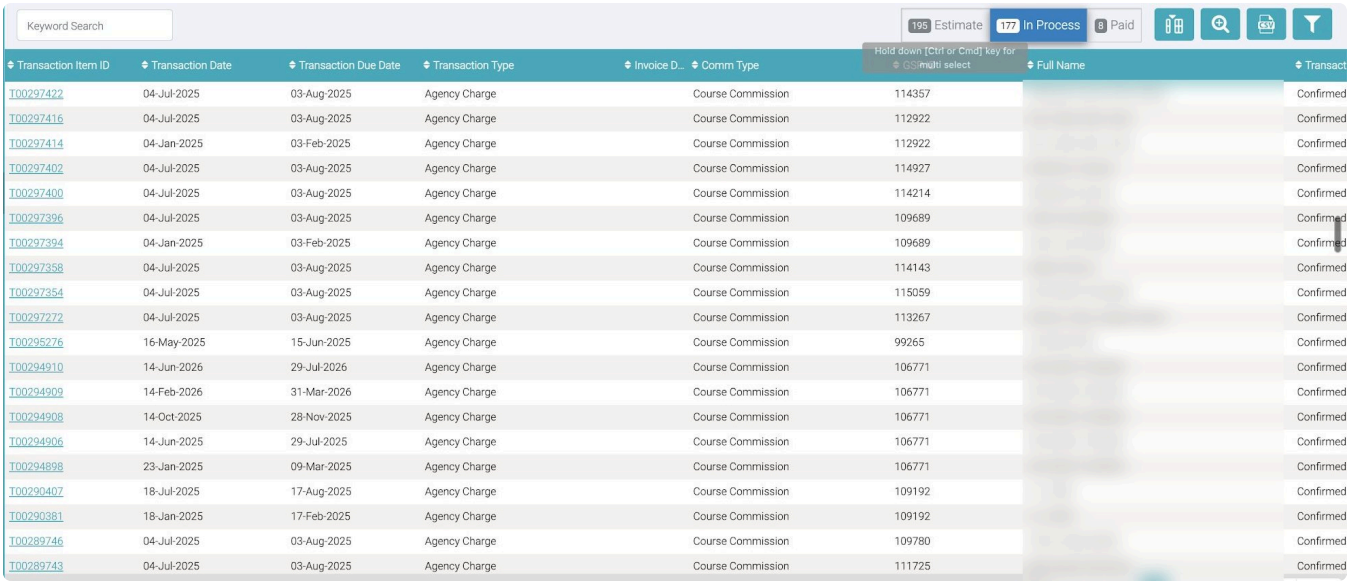


Turnaround: no clock anywhere

GSP's typical response is about **48 hours**. A 24-hour target exists informally, but nobody tracks it. Competitors respond in about 15 minutes to 2 hours (an internal estimate), and Leverage promises submission within a day. The report says cutting 48 hours to 24 isn't enough: the routing itself has to change (section 11).

Commission: a transaction list without rates

Agencies can't see the rate. RP1 couldn't tell whether AUD 354 was GSP's share or his. Invoicing happens off the portal (RP3), and payment notices arrive without the transfer receipt Nepal banks need, adding 1 to 2 days of emails per payout (RP11).



Transaction Item ID	Transaction Date	Transaction Due Date	Transaction Type	Invoice D...	Comm Type	GST	Full Name	Transact
T00297422	04-Jul-2025	03-Aug-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	114357		Confirmed
T00297416	04-Jul-2025	03-Aug-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	112922		Confirmed
T00297414	04-Jan-2025	03-Feb-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	112922		Confirmed
T00297402	04-Jul-2025	03-Aug-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	114927		Confirmed
T00297400	04-Jul-2025	03-Aug-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	114214		Confirmed
T00297396	04-Jul-2025	03-Aug-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	109689		Confirmed
T00297394	04-Jan-2025	03-Feb-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	109689		Confirmed
T00297358	04-Jul-2025	03-Aug-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	114143		Confirmed
T00297354	04-Jul-2025	03-Aug-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	115059		Confirmed
T00297272	04-Jul-2025	03-Aug-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	113267		Confirmed
T00295276	16-May-2025	15-Jun-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	99265		Confirmed
T00294910	14-Jun-2026	29-Jul-2026	Agency Charge		Course Commission	106771		Confirmed
T00294909	14-Feb-2026	31-Mar-2026	Agency Charge		Course Commission	106771		Confirmed
T00294908	14-Oct-2025	28-Nov-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	106771		Confirmed
T00294906	14-Jun-2025	29-Jul-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	106771		Confirmed
T00294898	23-Jan-2025	09-Mar-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	106771		Confirmed
T00290407	18-Jul-2025	17-Aug-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	109192		Confirmed
T00290381	18-Jan-2025	17-Feb-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	109192		Confirmed
T00289746	04-Jul-2025	03-Aug-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	109780		Confirmed
T00289743	04-Jul-2025	03-Aug-2025	Agency Charge		Course Commission	111725		Confirmed

7. Feature scorecard: GSP vs four competitors

Against the four competitor portals we could see, GSP is behind on most basics. This comes from 89 screenshots of live agency logins; "not seen" means it wasn't in the screenshots, not that it's missing.

Capability	GSP today	Best competitor practice
Fields to create a student	Partly: 10 required	KC: 4 · ApplyBoard: 5 plus consent · Leverage: 11 (feeds its eligibility warnings)
Fields to start an application	Missing: 20+ over 2 forms	KC: 4 · Leverage: 5 · Crizac: 6 · ApplyBoard: pick a student, then a 4-step check
Named case owner with phone on every application	Missing: BDM on the profile only	Crizac: handler, relationship manager and supervisor · KC: assignee and phone

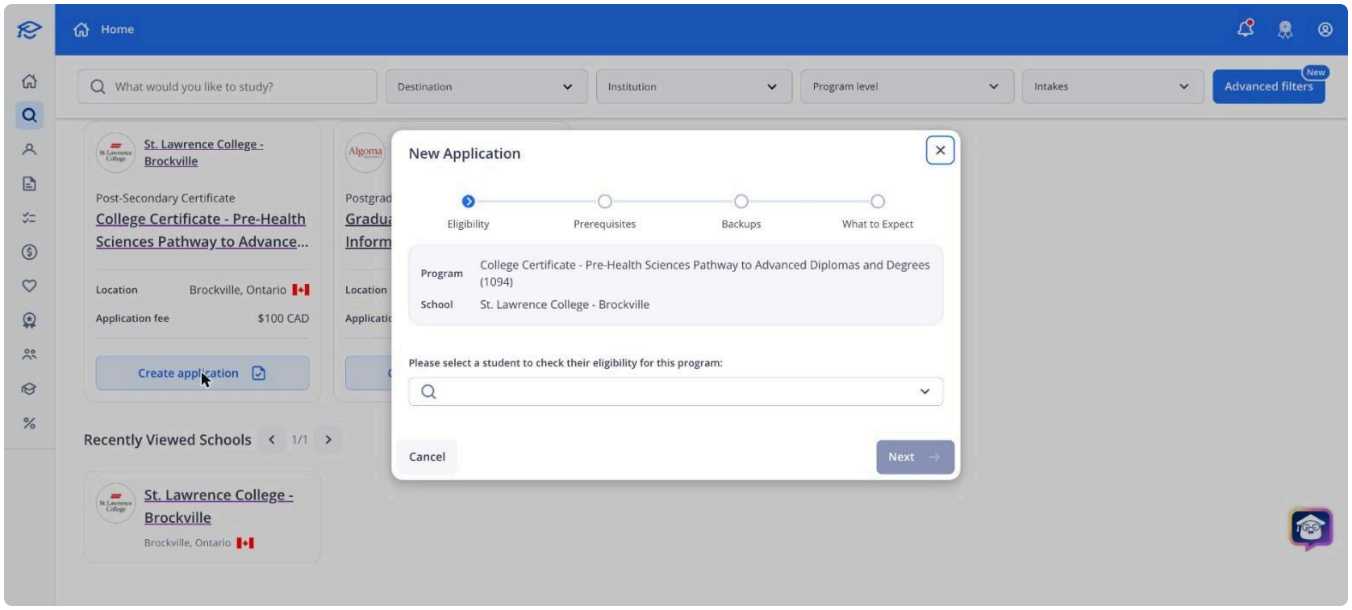
Capability	GSP today	Best competitor practice
Status that says whose turn it is	Missing: stage and generic status only	KC: "Pending from Partner – Academic Docs" · ApplyBoard: banner and 8-stage tracker · Crizac: primary and secondary status
University emails inside the application	Missing	Crizac only
Turnaround clock shown to the agency	Missing	Leverage: submission and offer times · KC: "Faster offer TAT" tags
Key deadlines on each application	Missing	Crizac, KC, ApplyBoard
Eligibility by nationality, state and school board before applying	Partly: a text advisory	Crizac: country × board table · KC: Eligible / Non-eligible split · ApplyBoard: student or guest filter
Mandatory vs optional documents per course	Partly: a free-text checklist	KC: upload once, reuse · Leverage: missing count, on hold · ApplyBoard: "Optional now, required later"
Commission rates visible to the agency	Missing: removed	Crizac: 867 rows, downloadable · Leverage: by region and intake · ApplyBoard: rate, % of net tuition, instalments
Commission and payout trail per student	Partly: transaction list	Crizac, Leverage and ApplyBoard: rate, ledger, invoice
Pipeline dashboard	Partly: an enrolment donut chart	All four; Leverage has a conversion funnel
Tickets with time targets	Partly: cases and notes	Leverage: "Delayed" count
Data freshness signal on courses	Missing	KC: "Last updated" and a report link · Crizac: a disclaimer

8. What each competitor does well

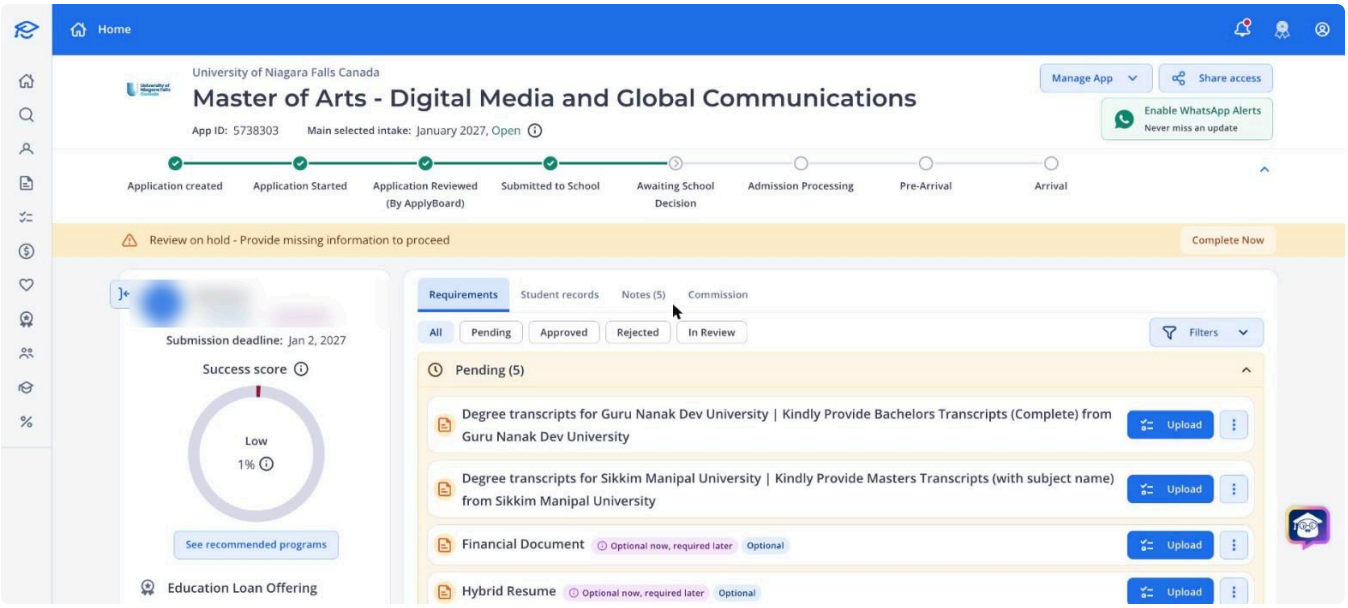
Each competitor solves one or two of our agencies' problems well; ApplyBoard is the one agencies hold up as the model. ApplyBoard was checked first-hand on 15 Oct 2026 in a read-only walkthrough; names in screenshots are blurred.

ApplyBoard: checks eligibility first, and tells the agent what to do next

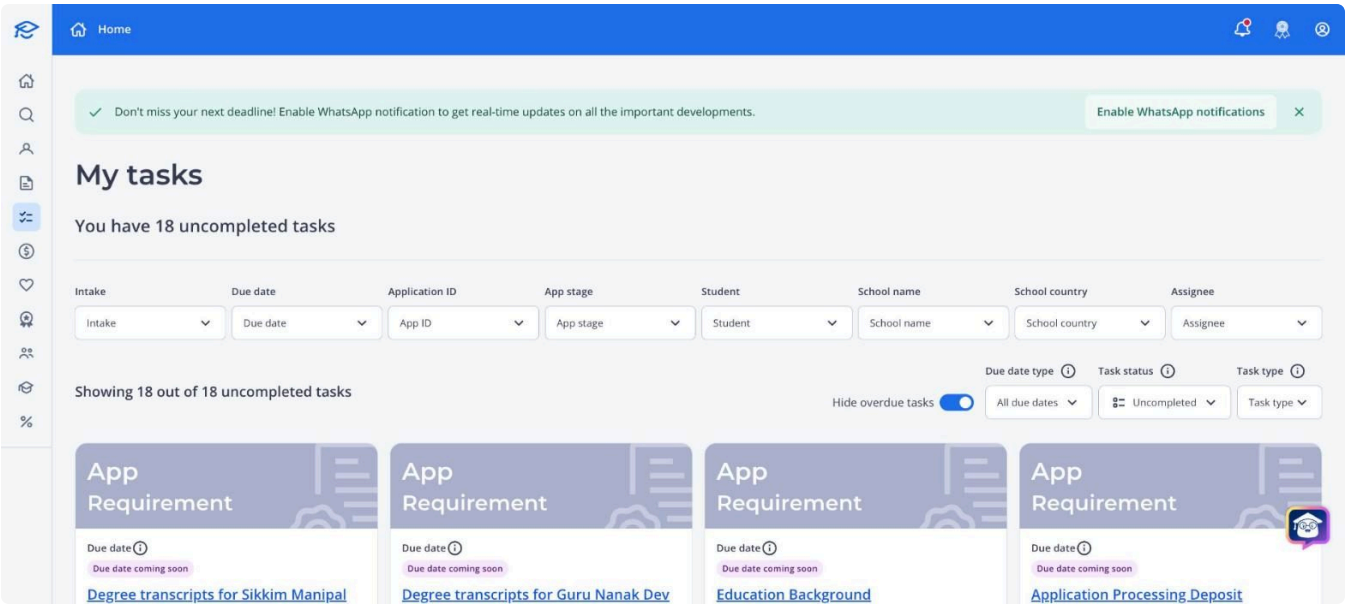
- **Search:** quick filters (Prime, Instant Submission, Exclude Pathway, PGWP, Scholarships), smart filters and saved filters. Each course card shows tags such as Instant Offer, Fast Acceptance and No Visa Cap, plus a **success chance**.
- **Eligibility before applying:** filters work for an existing student or a guest with no profile yet.
- **Add student:** 5 required fields and a consent tick, with passport autofill and bulk import.
- **New application:** pick the student, then four steps: Eligibility, Prerequisites, Backups, What to Expect.



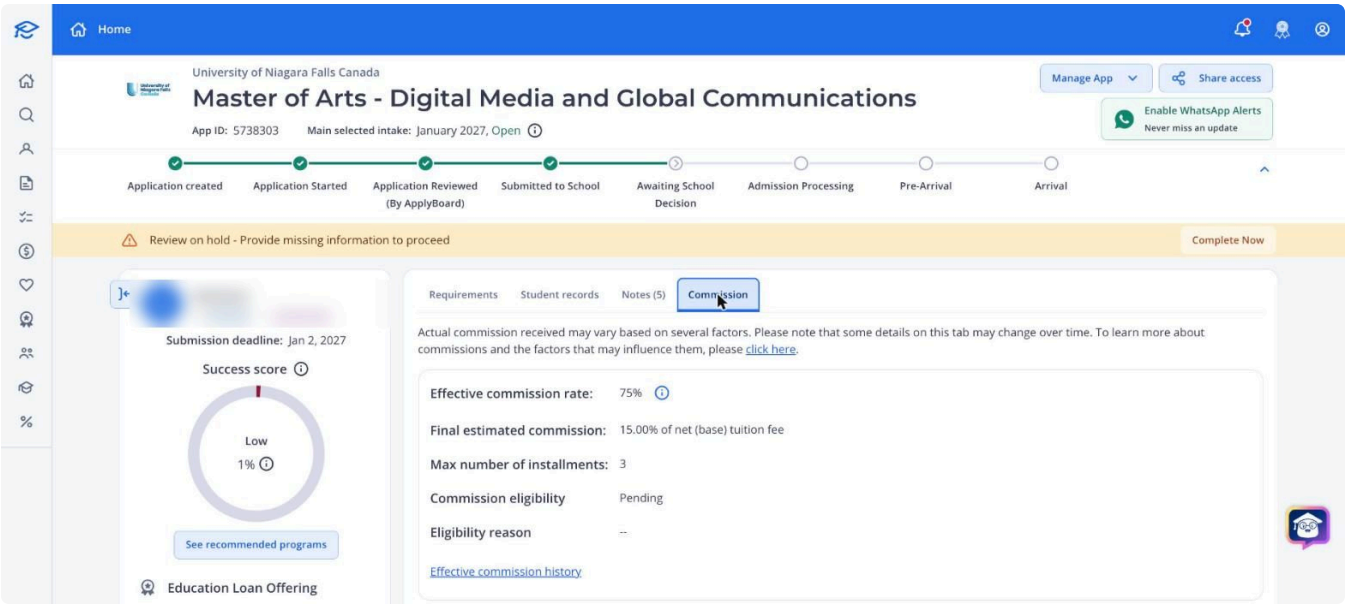
- **Application page:** an eight-stage tracker, a banner saying what the agent must do ("Review on hold – provide missing information"), requirements by state, notes, commission and WhatsApp alerts.
- **Applications list:** status, colour-coded requirement counts and current stage on one row.



- **My Tasks:** every open item across all applications (18 in the example), with due-date flags and filters for intake, stage, student, school, country and assignee.

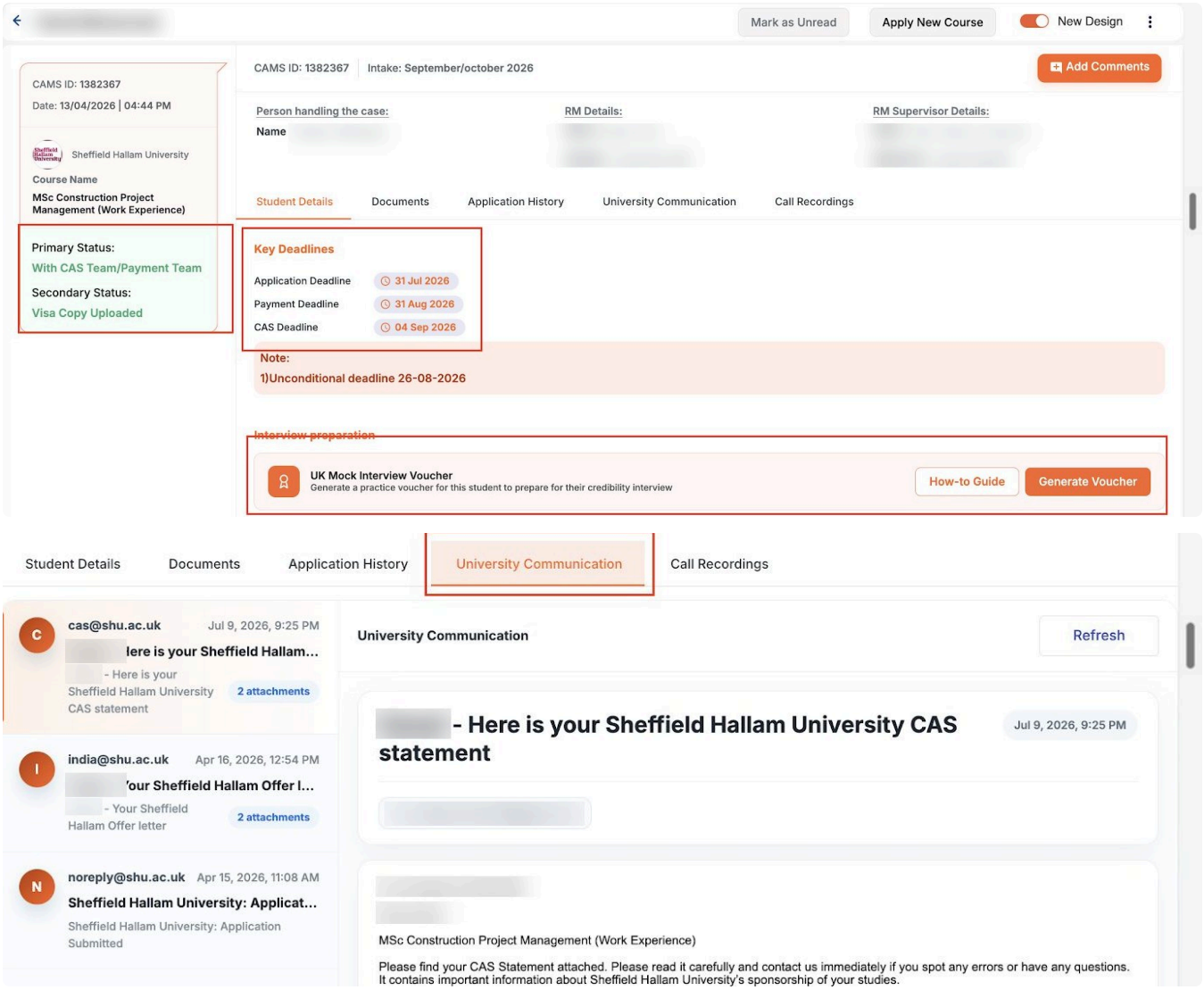


- **Commission per application:** effective rate (75%), 15% of net tuition, up to 3 instalments, eligibility status and rate history. **Payments** is a ledger with credits, debits and a withdrawal tied to an invoice number.
- **Elevate:** every partner earns at least 75%, up to 85% on points, in Gold, Platinum and Titanium tiers, with fee waivers and advance commission.
- **TrainHub:** 112 courses, from ApplyBoard basics to destination certifications and school-specific agent training.



Crizac: a named team, university emails, 24-hour offers

- Starts an application with **6 questions:** country, passport, intake, course type, university, course.
- Each application shows the case handler, relationship manager and supervisor with phone numbers, a primary and secondary status, and key deadlines.
- A **University Communication** tab shows the university's own emails on the application. Sri Lanka asked for exactly this.
- Minimum marks by country and school board (India CBSE 60%, Bangladesh 3.0/5, Nepal NEB 2.8/4).
- Every course lists its documents, tagged Mandatory.
- **867 commission rate rows**, filtered by passport country and intake, downloadable. Per student: gross fee, net fee, %, amount, status, then claim, ready for payment, paid, with receipts.
- Agents say it gives offers within 24 hours of the mandatory documents.



KC Overseas (Coursefinder.ai): eligible or not, before you apply

- Nationality and state up front, then one-click filters: Faster Offer TAT, scholarship, no interview, GS approval. Over 100,000 programmes, 4 fields to a result.
- Pick the student and results split into **Eligible** and **Non-eligible**, using state, school board and scores.
- Creating a student takes 4 fields; starting an application takes 4 (year, intake, university, programme), and only eligible programmes are offered.
- **Upload once:** each document shows which universities need it.
- Status in plain words: "Pending from Partner – Academic Documents", with priority, deadlines and comments split by team and student. A "Last updated" date on course data.

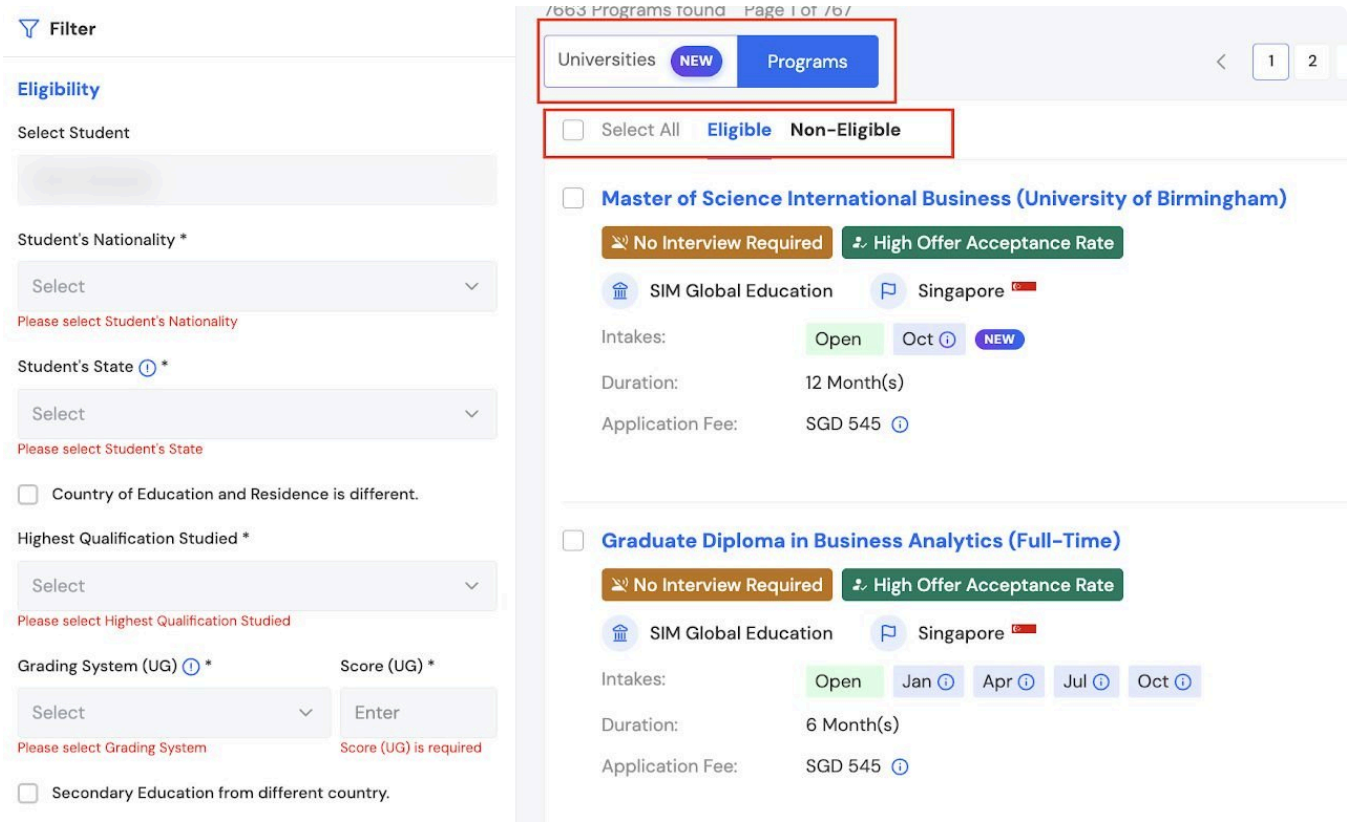


Image — KC documents: upload once, see which universities need each

Leverage Edu: a clock on every application, and self-serve commission

- Time taken at every stage, with the timer paused for holidays. Submission and offer times are columns in the main list.
- "3 missing" per application; applications stay on hold until mandatory documents arrive.
- Base commission and the tuition share that triggers payment, by region and intake.
- **Claim process:** the agent confirms enrolment and uploads proof; Leverage accepts or rejects with a visible reason; the agent approves each credit; a wallet in GBP and INR, and withdrawal creates an invoice.
- **Advance commission:** part of next intake's commission paid monthly against deposits and visas, for a 5% fee shown up front.

Image — Leverage time taken at every stage

Image — Leverage commission wallet in GBP and INR

The original report has 23 more competitor screenshots.

9. What works today and should be kept

Agencies praised GSP's speed, its people and its commission in several markets, so whatever we change should keep these.

- **Course cards** already carry IELTS, PTE, TOEFL and CAE scores, scholarships, fees and intakes. The data is good when it's current.
- **Bangladesh:** replies within 2 days, faster than Adventus and ApplyBoard. Commission shows exact amounts and calculations, and is paid on time.
- **Bangladesh (RP22):** no missing features, a WhatsApp group that works, and commission paid about a month after the invoice.
- **Nepal (RP12):** counsellors and admission officers find GSP helpful during counselling.
- **Hyderabad (RP10):** "Everything is in one portal."
- **Pakistan (RP16):** GSP's responsiveness is the best of the platforms it uses, and commission works.
- **Vietnam (RP27, RP28):** the only partner with a full commission portal and the best master agent in the market, with a partnership dating to 2017. The Vietnamese team is praised.
- **Indonesia (RP25) and the Philippines (RP17):** GSP is the top master agent in one and a preferred platform in the other.

10. Root causes: what sits behind the gaps

Most gaps trace back to how today's portal stores its data, not to its screens alone. Rows marked *round two* are guesses from agency reports that engineering still needs to confirm.

What agencies see	What sits behind it
Student, enrolment and application entered separately	A separate enrolment step sits between student and application. A primary/additional flag on the application would replace it
No pre-screen, no reminders	Document and eligibility rules are free text, so the system can't enforce, remind or check anything
Wrong or hidden commission	The system can't hold a flat rate and a tier together, or course-level rates. Staff cross-check three sources per case by hand
Territory rejections, lost contracts	Territory stops at country level. The only enforcement is a hard block, which has cost contracts
Slow, untracked responses	There is no case system: notes without queues, owners or time targets. University emails are re-routed by hand
Manual finance	No accounting (Xero) integration; transactions are matched one by one
Blind submissions; ended-contract institutes still searchable *(round two)*	Territory and contract status aren't part of the institute listing, so search can't filter on them
The same documents asked for on every application *(round two)*	Documents seem to attach to the application, not the student
Notifications reach the wrong person, or nobody *(round two)*	Alerts seem to follow the original handler, not the current owner or every counsellor

11. How an application moves: today vs proposed

Today a new application waits in two queues before anyone works on it; the proposal removes the central hop and gives every application a named owner with a clock.

Today an application waits in two queues before anyone works on it



how an application moves · today vs proposed

Red labels are the delays agencies feel today. The central team's owner already supports auto-routing, and the India admissions team couldn't say what the triage step adds.

- **Case layer:** every application is a case with an owner. Tickets come from the portal or a chatbot, and a dashboard shows anything late before the agency escalates.
- **One thread per application:** the agency, the case owner and the partnerships team in one thread, tagged "pending on GSP" or "pending on RP". It has to answer as fast as WhatsApp, or agencies won't move to it.

12. Two ways to close the gaps

The report offered two routes, or a mix: improve the current portal, or rebuild the core journeys. Either way, the business has to own structured data (document rules, territory rules, turnaround times, commission rules).

	Enhance the current portal	Rebuild core journeys
What it means	Add structured fields, rules and a case layer to existing parts; ship journey by journey	New search, apply-and-track and get-paid journeys on a new data model; move existing applications across
For it	Agencies see change sooner. No data move. Familiar screens. The "Now" fixes already live here	Removes the enrolment step. A commission model built for the 25 to 30 live contract types. A clean chance to meet competitors' UX
Against it	The enrolment step and commission limits stay unless reworked. Risk of adding complexity to an older UI	Longer before agencies see change. Moving existing data takes effort (engineering sees it as feasible if application states are aligned first)
What has to be true	The current data model can take structured rules and cases without major rework	Requirements agreed with the business before building starts

13. The end goal, and the order of fixes

The report's end goal is three upgrades (search, documents, a rule engine) held together by a case layer, delivered in three waves: Now, Next and Later.

The end goal, organised around the agency's journey

1. **Search, with the right information at the right level:** priority filters, fuzzy search, eligibility by nationality and state, turnaround and scholarship tags, a freshness date, territory and contract status on each listing, and courses pre-filtered from the student's profile.

2. **Documents the system can enforce:** mandatory or optional, templates, validity windows, country-specific checklists, one document set per student reused across applications, and auto-sorting of bulk uploads.
3. **A rule engine** that decides what to show, block or route: territory, eligibility, commission rules and routing, all held as data owned by the business, not in people's heads.
4. **Across all three, a case layer:** every application is a case with a named owner, a thread, a ticket queue fed by the portal and a chatbot, and a dashboard of time targets. University emails update the case automatically. Alerts go to the current owner and every counsellor, and each application has a chat with a bot and a 15-minute escalation.

Now: works on the current portal

- **P0, process:** send India agency applications straight to the India admissions queue.
- **P0, product:** system reminders for missing mandatory documents until they are uploaded.
- **P0, decision:** show commission rates to agency admins again, or an equivalent.
- **P1, process:** bring back submission status; check university portals every 24 hours and show "last checked".
- *Proposed, round two:* hide ended-contract institutes from search; show territory on each listing.
- *Proposed, round two:* alert the agent and current handler when an application is declined after enrolment.

Next: phase 1

- **P1:** structured document requirements: mandatory, template, validity.
- **P1:** a case thread with the owner of what's pending, a ticket queue and a time-target clock.
- **P1:** a commission rules engine for the 25 to 30 live contract types.
- **P1:** territory down to state and city; intake open or closed shown at search.
- **Structural:** simplify student → enrolment → application (e.g. a primary/additional flag).
- *Proposed, round two:* one document set per student, reused across applications.
- *Proposed, round two:* a staged application form: personal, then academic, then optional financial details.

Later: phase 2

- **P2:** a course-data pipeline with change alerts, prioritised by volume. Today about 300 of 900 universities are refreshed once or twice a year.
- **P2:** an eligibility pre-screen from verified documents.
- **P2:** auto-sorting of bulk document uploads.
- **P3:** text reading (OCR) on CoE, CAS and I-20; near-match university suggestions.
- *Proposed, round two:* an in-portal training hub and university updates.
- *Proposed, round two:* a commission wallet with one-click withdrawal, after the rules engine.

The waves hold whether GSP enhances or rebuilds; only the effort and timing change. Items marked *Proposed* came from round two and haven't been prioritised yet.

14. Decisions asked for, and who owns the data

The report asked leadership for three decisions and one owner for each set of data.

1. **Agree the problem.** The evidence covers ten markets, four competitors and GSP's own operations data.
2. **Commission visibility.** Show agency admins their rates by course level, as Crizac and Leverage do, or choose an equivalent.
3. **How to close the gaps.** Enhance the current portal, rebuild core journeys, or a mix. Engineering to bring effort estimates for both first.

Owner	What's needed from them	Status in the report
Head of University Partnerships / Data team	Structured data: document rules, state and city restrictions, offer turnaround per university. About 35,000 existing assessment-criteria records can be parsed	In progress
Finance	The commission rule catalogue; transfer notices attached to payouts	Done

Owner	What's needed from them	Status in the report
Recruitment and Admissions	The baseline mandatory document set by destination; tagging who owns what's pending; offer-letter data captured once, by whoever opens it first	In progress
CEO, Head of Recruitment India, Head of Recruitment Global	Named in the decision table; nothing listed yet	Blank

15. What this adds to the GSP 3.0 brief (my view)

The GSP 3.0 brief already answers most of this report: it picks the rebuild route and fixes the root causes in section 10. A few asks from agencies aren't in the brief yet and are worth raising.

Already answered by the brief

Report finding	How the brief answers it
Separate enrolment step	Removed: one application per student and intake, with primary and additional applications
Free-text rules	One eligibility engine with four verdicts and reasons; entry rules set at four levels
No owner, vague status	Every status has one owner, shown in colour and words; a named GSP contact from the first minute
Talking off the portal	Chat on every application, an AI assistant that answers first, WhatsApp alerts
University emails re-routed by hand	An email engine that places emails and moves the status
Documents re-uploaded	Student documents kept once and reused ("From the student record")
Long forms	Passport autofill; documents asked only when an application needs them

Report finding	How the brief answers it
Stale data	Course bots, Data team review, a "Checked on" date on each course
India central triage	Applications go straight to the region's queue, round robin
Territory by state	Search needs the student's state or province; blocked courses are hidden
Commission claims	The system works out commission and sends weekly self-billed statements

Not yet in the brief

- **Commission rate visibility for agency admins.** The report left this as an open decision; the brief's "You earn" suggests rates will show, but it should be confirmed.
- **Document templates and validity dates,** plus daily reminders for missing documents.
- **A turnaround time shown to the agency,** and the GSP contact's phone number.
- **Training hub, university updates and short onboarding** (some gaps are awareness, not features).
- **A pipeline view with export,** and a task list across all applications beyond "Needs you".
- **Duplicate-student block** when starting a second application.
- **Fuzzy search** for renamed universities.
- **A PGWP tag** for Canadian programmes.
- **Payout receipts** attached to each payment (Nepal banks need them).
- **Alerts for a decline after enrolment,** sent to the current owner and every counsellor.
- **A turnaround promise:** the report's case layer suggests a 15-minute escalation, while the brief targets a human reply within 2 working hours.

16. How the research was done

- **Round one:** 15 in-person and remote sessions, 23 Sep to 7 Oct 2026, with product, engineering and the CTO present.
- **Round two:** 13 more sessions (RP16 to RP28) up to 14 Oct 2026, covering six new markets and four more agencies in Bangladesh. These were coded from AI meeting notes (Granola), not full transcripts, so their counts are approximate.

- **Counts** are the number of sessions that raised a problem, out of 27 (the Myanmar session had no notes). Overlapping problems are merged under one parent. "Second applications" was only coded in round two.
- **Screenshots:** 89 from live agency logins of Crizac, KC Coursefinder.ai, Leverage Edu, ApplyBoard and GSP, captured in October 2026, with names blurred.
- **ApplyBoard** was reviewed first-hand on 15 Oct 2026 in a read-only walkthrough; nothing was created or changed. Some claims (one-click withdrawal, auto-credit) couldn't be tested.
- **Response times** (48 hours vs 15 minutes to 2 hours) are internal estimates from the 7 Oct prioritisation review.

Source: the field report "What Our Agents Told Us" (upGrad GSP Product, 23 Sep to 14 Oct 2026), which cites public sources on Crizac, KC Overseas, Leverage Edu and upGrad's acquisition of GSP.